

English Ladder

Student Workbook

Allow vs Prohibit: Understanding Usage in Different Contexts

A polished self-study handout designed for print or tablet use. Read the concept, notice the pattern, and then complete the matching practice set on your own.



Grammar Concepts #	1. Prevent vs Enab	2. Ineligible vs Qualifi	3. Refuse vs Agree / Reject vs A	4. Forbid vs Allow/Permit
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Visual anchor

Use the concept poster to spotlight the main language pattern in **Allow vs Prohibit: Understanding Usage in Different Contexts** and keep the explanation visible during practice and discussion.

ENGLISH LADDER

Concept #13 ► **Allow vs Prohibit**

There are many terms that refer to accepting or rejecting, but with slightly different meanings. Below are a few examples of common usage of these terms.

The distance to the girl's house **prevented** him from walking there.
His new car **enabled** him to quickly drive to the girl's house.
These terms are used for physical ability or inability.

They were **ineligible** for marriage since neither was 18 years old.
They were both **qualified** for marriage one year later.
These terms are used in the context of legal or official qualifications.

She **refused** | **agreed** to marry him.
She **rejected** | **accepted** his proposal.

The 1st line is about actions (marrying). The 2nd line is about things (proposal).

Her parents **forbid** | **allowed/permitted** them to marry.
These terms are use in contexts in which an authority makes a decision.

They were **banned** from the restaurant due to their loud argument.
This term is used when specific people have been "black-listed".

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Core Idea

The image highlights the distinctions between various terms related to accepting or rejecting actions or conditions. Below is a detailed explanation of each pair of terms along with additional examples to help non-native English speakers grasp the nuances of these terms.

1. Prevent vs Enable

These terms are used for physical ability or inability.

- Prevent: To stop something from happening. Example: The rain prevented us from going for a hike. Example: The strict rules prevented students from cheating on the exam.
- Enable: To make something possible. Example: Her encouragement enabled him to pursue his dreams. Example: The new software enabled faster data processing.

2. Ineligible vs Qualified

These terms are used in the context of legal or official qualifications.

- Ineligible: Not having the right to do or obtain something; disqualified. Example: He was ineligible to vote because he was underage. Example: The candidate was ineligible for the position due to a lack of experience.
- Qualified: Having the necessary skills, knowledge, or credentials. Example: She is qualified to teach English as she has a degree in the subject. Example: After passing the exams, they were qualified to drive.

3. Refuse vs Agree / Reject vs Accept

The first line in the examples is about actions (marrying). The second line is about things (proposal).

- Refuse: To indicate unwillingness to do something. Example: He refused to eat his vegetables. Example: She refused to participate in the project.
- Agree: To consent to do something. Example: He agreed to help with the homework. Example: She agreed to meet her friend for lunch.
- Reject: To dismiss or refuse an idea or proposal. Example: The committee rejected the proposal for the new policy. Example: He rejected the job offer as it didn't meet his expectations.
- Accept: To receive or agree to something. Example: She accepted the invitation to the party. Example: He accepted the challenge with enthusiasm.

4. Forbid vs Allow/Permit



These terms are used in contexts where an authority makes a decision.

- **Forbid:** To prohibit or order someone not to do something. Example: The school forbids students from using mobile phones in class. Example: Her parents forbade her from going out late at night.
- **Allow/Permit:** To let someone do something. Allow Example: The teacher allowed the students to leave early. Example: They allowed their children to play outside. Permit Example: The city permits street vendors to operate during festivals. Example: The rules permit students to bring snacks to school.

5. Ban

This term is used when specific people have been "black-listed."

- **Ban:** To officially or legally prohibit something. Example: The government banned smoking in public places. Example: The player was banned from the game for unsportsmanlike conduct.

Additional Examples to Illustrate the Concepts

- **Prevent vs Enable:** The heavy traffic prevented us from arriving on time. The new bridge enabled easier access to the island.
- **Ineligible vs Qualified:** She was ineligible for the scholarship because she missed the deadline. He is qualified to run the marathon as he completed the required training.
- **Refuse vs Agree:** He refused to sign the contract without reading it first. She agreed to volunteer at the community center.
- **Reject vs Accept:** They rejected the applicant due to insufficient qualifications. She accepted the award on behalf of her team.
- **Forbid vs Allow/Permit:** The law forbids driving without a license. The manager allowed the employees to work from home. The policy permits flexible working hours.
- **Ban:** The school banned the use of plastic bottles on campus. He was banned from the club for breaking the rules.

Understanding these subtle differences can help non-native speakers use these terms accurately and effectively in various contexts.



Practice Check

Answer the quiz questions below with responses consistent with the grammar concepts taught on the left.

ITEM 01

The teacher _____ (prevented/enabled) the students from cheating during the exam.

Answer: _____

ITEM 02

Her encouragement _____ (prevented/enabled) him to pursue his dreams.

Answer: _____

ITEM 03

They were _____ (ineligible/qualified) for the competition because they missed the registration deadline.

Answer: _____

ITEM 04

After completing the training, he felt _____ (ineligible/qualified) to perform the task.

Answer: _____

ITEM 05

She _____ (refused/agreed) to join the club because she had other commitments.

Answer: _____

**ITEM 06**

He _____ (agreed/declined) to help his friend with the project.

Answer: _____

ITEM 07

The committee _____ (rejected/accepted) the proposal for the new policy.

Answer: _____

ITEM 08

She _____ (accepted/rejected) the invitation to the party.

Answer: _____

ITEM 09

The school _____ (forbids/allows) students to use mobile phones during class.

Answer: _____

ITEM 10

The company _____ (allows/forbids) employees to work from home.

Answer: _____

ITEM 11

The government _____ (forbids/permits) smoking in public places.

Answer: _____

**ITEM 12**

The city _____ (permits/bans) street vendors to operate during festivals.

Answer: _____

ITEM 13

The rain _____ (prevented/enabled) us from going for a hike.

Answer: _____

ITEM 14

Her new shoes _____ (enabled/prevented) her to run faster.

Answer: _____

ITEM 15

He was _____ (ineligible/qualified) for the scholarship because of his grades.

Answer: _____

ITEM 16

After years of experience, she felt _____ (qualified/ineligible) to lead the team.

Answer: _____

ITEM 17

He _____ (refused/agreed) to attend the meeting because he was busy.

Answer: _____

**ITEM 18**

She _____ (agreed/refused) to lend him some money.

Answer: _____

ITEM 19

The board _____ (rejected/accepted) the candidate for the job.

Answer: _____

ITEM 20

She _____ (accepted/rejected) the gift with a smile.

Answer: _____

ITEM 21

The teacher _____ (allowed/forbade) the students to leave early.

Answer: _____

ITEM 22

Her parents _____ (forbade/permitted) her from going to the party.

Answer: _____

ITEM 23

The school _____ (banned/permitted) the use of plastic bottles on campus.

Answer: _____



ITEM 24

The city _____ (permits/bans) vendors from selling without a license.

Answer: _____



Self-check Answer Key

Use the key after you have completed every item on your own.

Item 01 prevented Feedback: "Enabled" is incorrect because it means to make something possible. The phrase "from cheating" requires a term that stops an action, making "prevented" correct. "Enabled the students from" would be grammatically incorrect.

Item 02 enabled Feedback: "Prevented" is incorrect because it means to stop something from happening. The phrase "to pursue his dreams" requires a term that facilitates an action, making "enabled" correct. "Prevented him to" would be grammatically incorrect.

Item 03 ineligible Feedback: "Qualified" is incorrect because it means having the necessary skills or credentials. The phrase "missed the registration deadline" indicates a lack of eligibility, making "ineligible" correct. "Qualified for the competition because they missed" would be logically inconsistent.

Item 04 qualified Feedback: "Ineligible" is incorrect because it means not having the right to do something. The phrase "after completing the training" indicates having the necessary credentials, making "qualified" correct. "Ineligible to perform" would be logically inconsistent.

Item 05 refused Feedback: "Agreed" is incorrect because it means to consent to do something. The phrase "had other commitments" indicates an unwillingness to join, making "refused" correct. "Agreed to join because she had other commitments" would be logically inconsistent.

Item 06 agreed Feedback: "Declined" is incorrect because it means to refuse. The phrase "to help his friend" indicates a willingness, making "agreed" correct. "Declined to help his friend" would be logically inconsistent.

Item 07 rejected Feedback: "Accepted" is incorrect because it means to receive or agree to something. The phrase "the proposal for the new policy" indicates a dismissal, making "rejected" correct. "Accepted the proposal for" would be logically inconsistent given the context.

Item 08 accepted Feedback: "Rejected" is incorrect because it means to dismiss or refuse an idea. The phrase "the invitation to the party" indicates a positive response, making "accepted" correct. "Rejected the invitation" would be logically inconsistent given the context.

Item 09 forbids Feedback: "Allows" is incorrect because it means to let someone do something. The structure "forbids [someone] to [do something]" or "forbids [someone] from [doing something]" is commonly used, making "forbids" correct. "Allows students to use mobile phones" would be logically inconsistent given the context.

Item 10 allows Feedback: "Forbids" is incorrect because it means to prohibit. The structure "allows [someone] to [do something]" indicates permission, making "allows" correct. "Forbids employees to work from home" would be logically inconsistent given the context.

Item 11 forbids Feedback: "Permits" is incorrect because it means to allow. The structure "forbids [something] in [some place]" indicates prohibition, making "forbids" correct. "Permits smoking in public places" would be



logically inconsistent given the context.

Item 12 permits Feedback: "Bans" is incorrect because it means to officially or legally prohibit something. The structure "permits [someone] to [do something]" indicates permission, making "permits" correct. "Bans street vendors to operate" would be grammatically incorrect.

Item 13 prevented Feedback: "Enabled" is incorrect because it means to make something possible. The structure "prevented [someone] from [doing something]" indicates stopping an action, making "prevented" correct. "Enabled us from going" would be grammatically incorrect.

Item 14 enabled Feedback: "Prevented" is incorrect because it means to stop something from happening. The structure "enabled [someone] to [do something]" indicates facilitation, making "enabled" correct. "Prevented her to run" would be grammatically incorrect.

Item 15 ineligible Feedback: "Qualified" is incorrect because it means having the necessary skills or credentials. The phrase "because of his grades" indicates disqualification, making "ineligible" correct. "Qualified for the scholarship because of his grades" would be logically inconsistent given the context.

Item 16 qualified Feedback: "Ineligible" is incorrect because it means not having the right to do something. The phrase "years of experience" indicates competence, making "qualified" correct. "Ineligible to lead the team" would be logically inconsistent given the context.

Item 17 refused Feedback: "Agreed" is incorrect because it means to consent. The phrase "because he was busy" indicates unwillingness, making "refused" correct. "Agreed to attend because he was busy" would be logically inconsistent.

Item 18 agreed Feedback: "Refused" is incorrect because it means to indicate unwillingness. The phrase "to lend him some money" indicates willingness, making "agreed" correct. "Refused to lend him" would be logically inconsistent given the context.

Item 19 rejected Feedback: "Accepted" is incorrect because it means to receive or agree to something, and is followed by the preposition "for". In contrast, "rejected" is usually used without the preposition "for" such as, "The board rejected the job candidate." "Accepted the candidate for the job" would be grammatically inconsistent given the context.

Item 20 accepted Feedback: "Rejected" is incorrect because it means to dismiss or refuse an idea or proposal. The phrase "with a smile" indicates a positive reception, making "accepted" correct. "Rejected the gift with a smile" would be logically inconsistent.

Item 21 allowed Feedback: "Forbade" is incorrect because it means to prohibit or order someone not to do something. The structure "allowed [someone] to [do something]" indicates permission, making "allowed" correct. "Forbade the students to leave early" would be grammatically incorrect.



Item 22 forbade Feedback: "Permitted" is incorrect because it means to allow someone to do something. The structure "forbade [someone] from [doing something]" indicates prohibition, making "forbade" correct. "Permitted her from going" would be grammatically incorrect.

Item 23 banned Feedback: "Permitted" is incorrect because it means to allow someone to do something. The structure "banned [something] on [some place]" indicates prohibition, making "banned" correct. "Permitted the use of plastic bottles on campus" would be logically inconsistent given the context.

Item 24 bans Feedback: "Permits" is incorrect because it means to allow someone to do something. The structure "bans [someone] from [doing something]" indicates prohibition, making "bans" correct. "Permits vendors from selling" would be grammatically incorrect.
